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Hiring Committee
Housing Alliance of Pennsylvania
1501 Cherry Street
Philadelphia, PA 19102

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am excited to apply for the Policy Director position with the Housing Alliance of Pennsylvania. Your mission resonates strongly with me because safe, decent, and affordable housing is foundational to health, family stability, and opportunity. Throughout my career, I have worked at the intersection of public policy, advocacy, and community well-being, helping organizations turn research, stakeholder input, and legislative strategy into action. I am especially drawn to the Housing Alliance's commitment to organizing with providers, partners, and people with lived experience to advance practical housing and homelessness solutions across Pennsylvania.

Over the past eight years, I have built a career around policy, advocacy, and stakeholder engagement. At Venture Global Consulting, I advanced client policy priorities through direct engagement with legislators, legislative staff, and external stakeholders, while developing advocacy materials such as op-eds, letters of support, and reports. At CADCA, I managed bipartisan stakeholder engagement across congressional chambers and developed advocacy toolkits and legislative alerts used by more than 5,000 coalition members. Earlier, as a Legislative Fellow with the Women's Congressional Policy Institute, I managed a congressional health policy portfolio and coordinated stakeholder engagement to help inform legislative priorities. Across these roles, I developed the skills to build relationships, navigate competing perspectives, and keep policy initiatives moving in mission-driven environments.

I would also bring strong policy analysis and policy education experience to this role. At the Prenatal-to-Three Policy Impact Center at the LBJ School of Public Affairs, I conducted evidence reviews and policy research on issues including Medicaid expansion, group prenatal care, doula services, and screening programs for children. I translated complex findings into technical briefs and annual reports designed to inform agencies and policymakers making funding and program decisions. That work strengthened my ability to digest complicated policy questions, communicate them clearly to different audiences, and support advocacy with well-grounded analysis.

While my background has centered on health and prevention policy rather than housing policy specifically, the throughline of my work has been clear: helping mission-driven organizations develop policy priorities, engage partners, and advocate for better outcomes for families and communities. I would bring that same discipline, curiosity, and collaborative approach to Pennsylvania's housing and homelessness landscape. Based in South Jersey, I am available for regular in-person work in Philadelphia and frequent travel to Harrisburg. After spending the last several years focused on full-time caregiving, I am eager to return to full-time policy leadership in a role where strong advocacy, coalition-building, and clear communication can directly support lasting systems change.

Thank you for your consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my legislative, coalition, and policy research experience could support the Housing Alliance's agenda and help strengthen advocacy for safe and affordable housing across Pennsylvania.

Sincerely,

Nicole Semenza, LSW